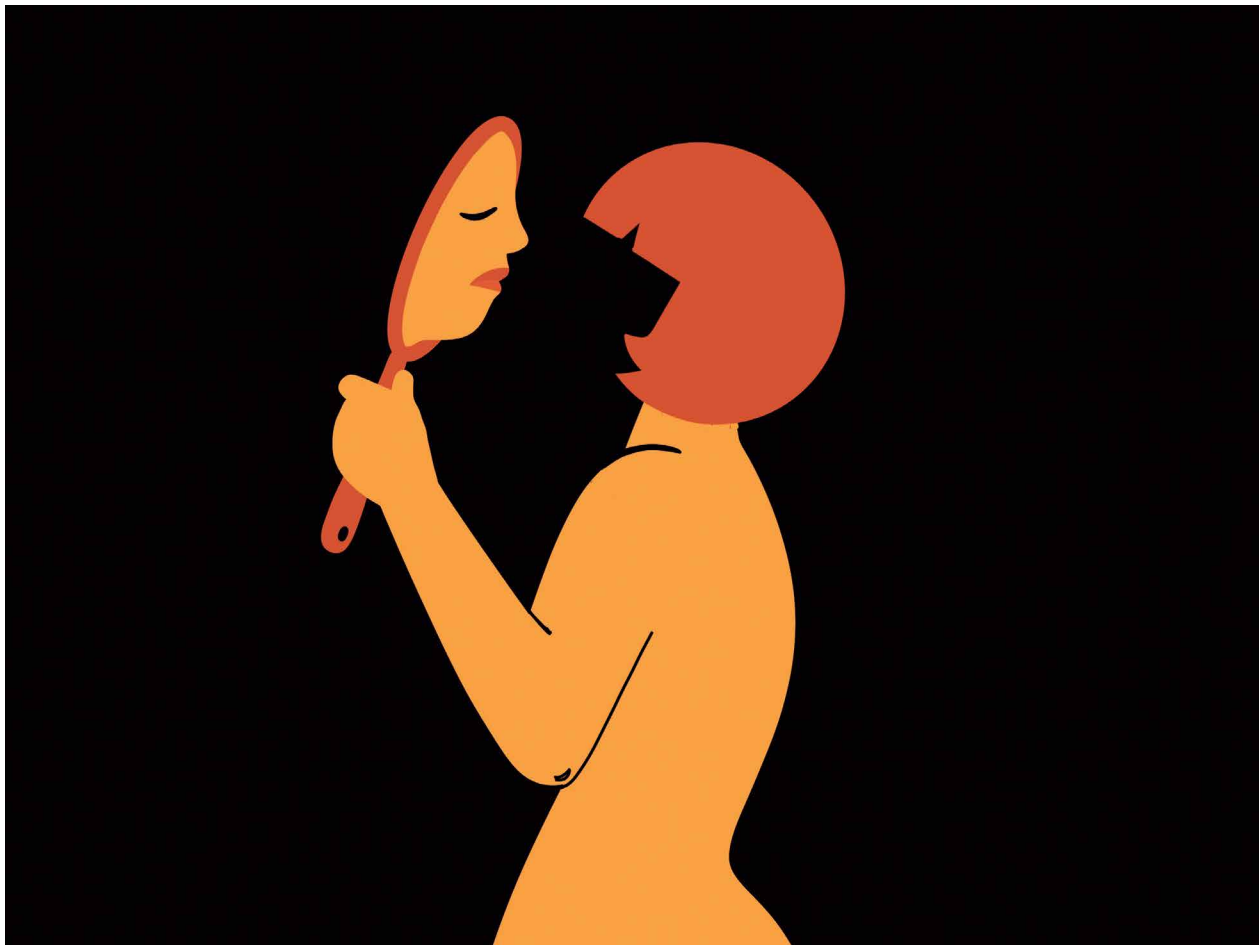


Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

Unfortunately, women are conditioned to feel that pain is part of the package and that it's normal. But we are here to change that narrative. At That Sassy Thing, we are flipping the script by creating products prioritising vulva owners and their pleasure. Our bestselling massager, LIT, has emerged as a liberator for so many of our customers. We've had customers who've been married for over 10 years writing to us that they experienced an orgasm for the first time using LIT. That's super encouraging and empowering for us.

SEXUAL WELLNESS PRODUCTS SHOULDN'T BE JUST A 'WANT' BUT A 'NEED'

How business can change mindsets

Naturally, we need more women in positions of power to come forward and talk about body positivity and sexual health. Sadly, that is not the case in India. I remember talking to a woman investor who told me that sexual wellness products are a 'want', not a 'need'. This mindset has to change and women need to be at the forefront of that revolution. The funding landscape already has very few women investors and the sexual wellness space isn't getting the support it deserves. And though I understand how bringing change can take time, I am sure we will be able to make it happen, one day at a time.

I believe a business can be profitable and do greater good at the same time. So, we're not just about selling pleasure products but also want to educate people about how to use them to start their own sexual wellness journey. We've also launched India's first online, free, queer, and trans-affirmative Masterclasses on Sex Ed, in collaboration with sexuality experts in India. Our goal is to provide people with language and resources relevant to their sexual wellness journey. In keeping with our larger vision to build for Bharat, we recently started a masterclass in Hinglish (Hindi + English) on 'Consent' and are soon launching one in Tamil + English on 'Intimacy After Childbirth'.

We're making sex education accessible, inclusive and realistic for people of diverse identities, ages and bodies, across regions. With credible Sex Ed, we believe we can empower more and more people to take ownership of their bodies and, in turn, normalise all things sex. I envision a world where sex care is as mainstream as skincare. ■

Sachee Malhotra is founder, That Sassy Thing, a wellness brand